

Integrated Core + Cluster Physical Examination Framework

The core examination: 24 maneuvers in 7 sections, plus 3 universal items

#	Section	Maneuver
	General appearance and vital signs	5 maneuvers
1		Observes general appearance
2		Assesses orientation (person, place, time)
3		Measures blood pressure
4		Measures heart rate (pulse)
5		Measures respiratory rate
	HEENT and cranial nerve screen	4 maneuvers
6		Inspects external eye and lid
7		Assesses pupillary light reflex (CN II/III)
8		Inspects oropharynx and dentition
9		Palpates cervical lymph nodes
	Cardiac	2 maneuvers
10		Palpates chest for point of maximal impulse (PMI)
11		Auscultates heart in 4 areas
	Pulmonary	3 maneuvers
12		Percusses posterior chest (3 levels)
13		Auscultates posterior chest (3 levels)
14		Auscultates anterior chest (2 levels)
	Abdomen	4 maneuvers
15		Inspects abdomen
16		Auscultates abdomen before palpation
17		Performs light abdominal palpation (all 4 quadrants)
18		Performs deep abdominal palpation (all 4 quadrants)
	Vascular	3 maneuvers
19		Palpates posterior tibial pulses (bilateral)
20		Palpates dorsalis pedis pulses (bilateral)
21		Palpates lower extremity for edema
	Neurologic	3 maneuvers
22		Assesses gross UE motor strength (≥ 2 groups each arm)
23		Assesses gross LE motor strength (≥ 2 groups each leg)
24		Assesses gait

Universal items — performed in every encounter, counted separately

Washes hands BEFORE exam · Observes proper draping · Washes hands AFTER exam

Maneuvers from Gowda's national core now placed in clusters

Relocated, not removed. Each is performed when the presenting problem indicates its cluster.

#	Maneuver in Gowda's core	Now in this cluster
1	Carotid artery palpation	Cardiac
2	Jugular venous pulse	Cardiac
3	Cardiac auscultation with bell at apex	Cardiac
4	Liver palpation	Gastrointestinal
5	Thyroid palpation	Endocrine / HEENT
6	Deep tendon reflexes (biceps, patellar)	Neuro-vestibular
7	Sensory exam (light touch or pinprick)	Neuro-vestibular

Note on the arithmetic

Gowda's national consensus core holds 37 maneuvers. Seven appear above as cluster maneuvers, leaving 30. The difference between 30 and our 24 comes from items this framework folds into another task or records rather than performs (level of consciousness, temperature, height/weight/BMI, skin inspection, inspection of extremities and joints, assessment of speech, inguinal lymph nodes, thorax inspection). The mapping is not one-to-one and should be checked against the derivation record before it is published as a maneuver-by-maneuver account.